

Referee Reports

When you submit a paper...

Author(s)

Submit to a journal



Editor

Look for potential referees

In very few cases, the Editor can immediately reject the paper and doesn't look for referees.

Very unusual, but it can be common for Science and Nature

ApJ, AJ, A&A, MNRAS:

1 referee

Icarus, Elsevier journals:

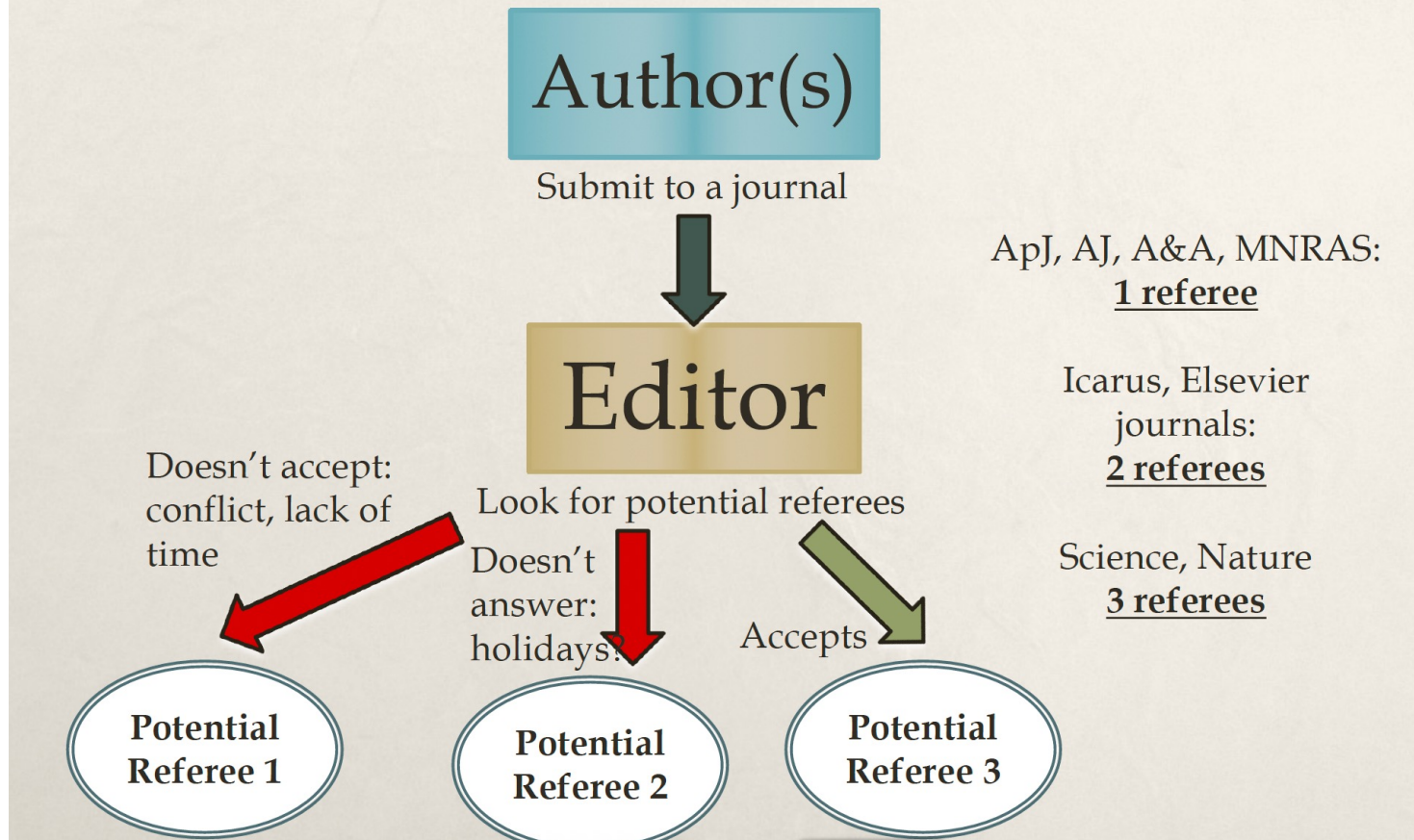
2 referees

Science, Nature

3 referees

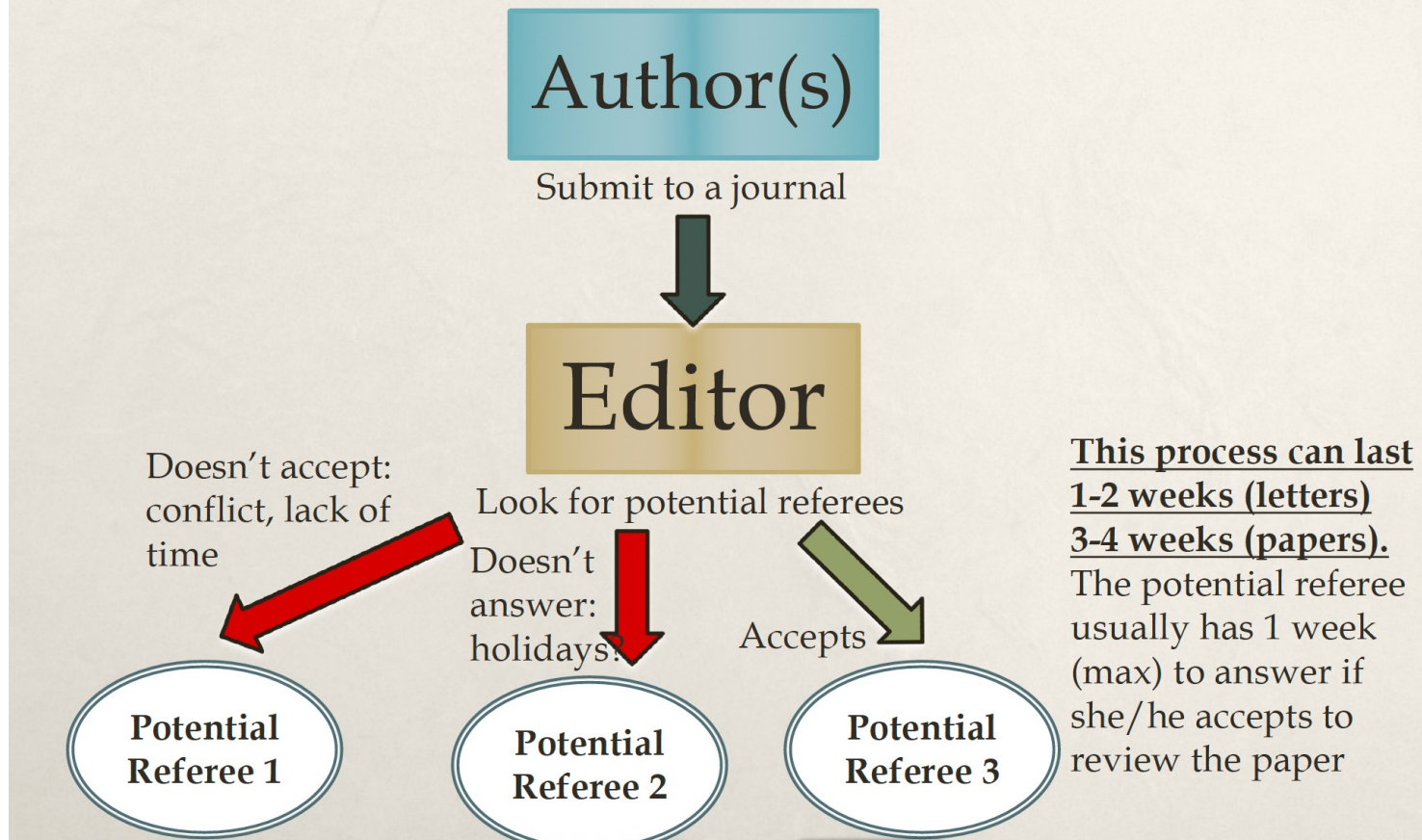
Courtesy:
Paola Pinilla

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Send report

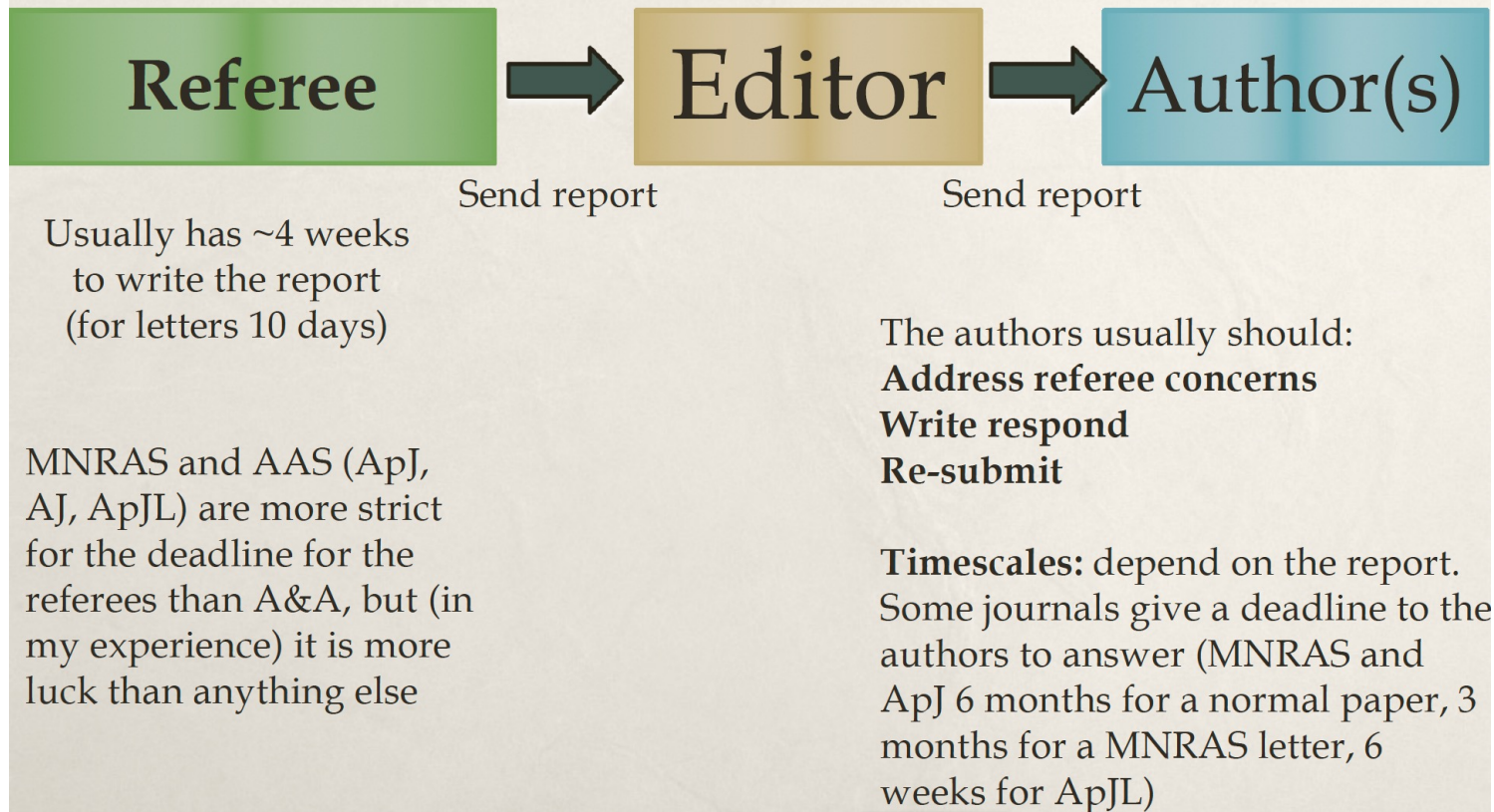
Send report

Usually has ~4 weeks
to write the report
(for letters 10 days)

MNRAS and AAS (ApJ,
AJ, ApJL) are more strict
for the deadline for the
referees than A&A, but (in
my experience) it is more
luck than anything else

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Why might you want to be a referee?

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- **Line on your CV** – demonstrates that you are perceived as expert in the field.
- **Service** – you are an expert in your subject area and your expertise is needed to improve the quality of the work conducted in the field
- **Learning** – it is a useful skill to learn how to help another person improve the quality of their research and how to think critically/constructively about a research project. Makes you a better researcher and advisor.

How do you become a referee?

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- Inform your advisor and senior collaborators that you would be interested in this opportunity and the subject matter you'd feel like you can review . They can refer editors to you if they get asked.
- Your advisor can request that you be the referee and inform the editor that they will work with you to ensure the quality of the review.

How do you **write** a referee report ?

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AAS Journals: Questions to keep in mind as you read the article

- Does the paper present original research at a level appropriate for an AJ paper?
- Is the abstract informative?
- Does the article represent a significant contribution to the astronomical literature?
- Are the results adequately documented (e.g., are relevant data included)?
- Could any of the figures or tables be more effectively presented as online-only material in the electronic version of the journal?
- Are errors and uncertainties given and explained?
- Is there sufficient reference to previous work?
- Is the material clearly presented?

How do you **write** a referee report ?

Major Comments:

High Level – Is the scientific value sufficient to merit publication?

- This can be subjective.

My Approach:

- Does the research advance our understanding of the topic?
- If yes, then it deserves publication and your approach is how to make the paper have the most impact.
- If no, then it still MIGHT deserve publication and your approach is how to help the authors get it to that level?